

Council Meeting
May 8, 2019
Page 1

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, May 8, 2019, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present were:

At-Large Councilor Claire Lessard
Ward I Councilor Andrew O'Hearne - arrived at 6:52pm
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone
Assistant Mayor Allen Damren
Mayor Charlene Lovett
At-Large Councilor Abigail Kier
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Ward II Councilor Scott Pope

Also present:

John MacLean, Interim City Manager
Mary Walter, Finance Director

Members of the Council absent were:
At-Large Councilor Jeremy Zullo

AGENDA CHANGES

Mayor Lovett stated that 3 items were being pulled from the agenda
-*Food Truck Policy Ordinance 567 – First Reading – Public Hearing* to go back to the policy committee and put on the May 22nd meeting for first reading
-City Fee Schedule – was passed at the 4/24/19 meeting
-CM update on Encroachment on Rail Trail (from 3/13 meeting) – move to June 12th meeting
-Add a non-public for personnel at the end of the meeting

REPORT OF SECRETARY

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Stone to accept the minutes of March 27, 2019, city council meeting

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0

City Manager had also requested that we approve the minutes from February 13 and 27, 2019. While it had been delayed since Ms. Russell had been out and she had been the one to type them, there were some councilors that felt they weren't as robust as they have been, however, their training had said that minutes were not to be transcribed but to be a summary.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Kier to accept the minutes of the February 13, 2019 & February 27, 2019, City Council meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0

MAYOR'S NOTES

Proclamation – Alan Chamberlain

Mayor Lovett presented Alan Chamberlain with a proclamation for his 30 years of service to Claremont Fire Department.

Proclamation – Mental Health Awareness Month

Mayor Lovett said May is Mental Health Awareness Month and, for the first time, the Master Plan has a public health section and wanted to give Dave Putnam credit for helping to get it into the Master Plan.

Mayor Lovett presented the proclamation to Suellen Griffin, Executive Director of West Central Behavioral Health, for her dedication in bringing the issues of mental health forward, the efforts that the organization makes in helping the community and trainings that are offered to help others in recognizing it as well as resources provided to help those families experiencing it.

Proclamation – Stevens High School Alumni Week

Mayor Lovett presented members of the Stevens High School Alumni Association the proclamation. This is said to be the oldest continuous alumni association in the US – and gave a little history about Stevens School – built in 1867 which was only 2 years after the Civil War and, at a time of economic upheaval and unrest, it was a generous donation and foresight to invest in the school. The alumni association will be celebrating 148 years. Parade will be June 8th commencing at 10:30am.

Earth Day was April 22nd the weather has not been very cooperative. Many groups have been working hard including Stevens High School students who were busy on the 19th with their cleanup day. This past Sunday the Rotary helped the Mayor clean up Grissom Lane.

April 20th the transfer station collected 1,500 tires on free tire day.

A reminder that the remainder of the Budgets will be presented at a hearing this Saturday starting at 9:00am with a 1-hour lunch at noon.

Mayor Lovett reported that she was at the state house yesterday for the Senate Finance Committee hearing on the proposed budget – there was a big turnout – big representation. She waited through the first 5 hours of testimony because there were some many people signed up to speak, they broke for dinner and she finally got to address the legislators in the evening session that went from 6-8 pm. Frank Sprague testified and she didn't want to reiterate what he'd said so she talked about the effects of the recession, losing \$110 million in value in 2014, the tax rate going up \$5.00 overnight without us doing anything and the long term effects that the loss of revenue sharing, NHRS sharing for Group II and Teachers has had and that there is no way to make up these cuts on the property taxpayers.

SB247, lead poisoning law, was to increase DHHS personnel to accommodate the number of children that will need services as they start testing 100% of young children and decrease the level of allowable lead in the systems. The cut of \$100,000 out of the department requested budget is worrisome.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Made one appointment to the Claremont Housing Authority board, still have two more vacancies if anyone in the public is interested. Please contact the City Manager's office.

Public Works Director Vic St Pierre and Projects Manager Thomas Krebs each received a training certificate for pedestrian and crosswalk safety.

Parks & Recreation Director Mark Brislin submitted his re-certification of his designation as a Certified Park and Recreation Professional (CPRP).

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

None

CITIZEN'S FORUM

None

OLD BUSINESS

City Manager Search Update

Mr. Damren stated the board met this past Tuesday, we were able to the get the manger ad posted on several websites and thanks to city staff who helped make this happen. Posted on several sites such as ICMA, NHMA, SGR, Indeed. They are also looking into several state sites similar to

NHMA operating in the other New England States. We've had 10 applications received as of today, and feels that there is no reason to delay interviews prior to the closing date of June 4th.

Primex is helping us at no cost with sample interview questions, what to expect in the process and, if we want to have written assessments on some of the top candidates it would be \$40.00 per written assessment.

Food Truck Policy Ordinance 567 – First Reading – Public Hearing

This has been sent back to the Policy Committee. Moved to June 12th meeting.

NEW BUSINESS

Authorize City Manager to enter into agreement with New England Family Housing – 147 Main Street

John MacLean explained that we need to delay this, but wanted to give an update– we have met and continue discussions but have not yet come to an agreement on the language regarding the lease.

Mr. Koloski said he has a lot of questions and has a problem with us giving something away to get a release signed.

Both sides have worked with good intentions and we have negotiated in good faith, just working on the language. He believes there is fairness in continuing this and he's going against what would normally be done which would be to conduct these discussions in non-public but he's trying to be as open and transparent as possible.

Mr. O'Hearne feels we should be doing this in non-public. Several others agreed. Mayor Lovett asked to put it on the May 22nd agenda as a non-public.

LCHIP Grant – 58 Opera House Square, City Hall

Director Merrill said we applied for a LCHIP grant last year based on the assessment that we had done and we were not successful. One of their comments was that it was too big. Although they give out up to \$500,000 in grants, they want something smaller so that the funds can be shared with more communities. The grant is open again this year and this application will be specific to the copper roof, not more than \$750,000. We would like your approval for us to apply for this grant. However, this is not the only problem we have with the city hall roof; we have a flat roof area of that needs replacing which we thought we were addressing with the \$100,000 in the budget for FY19. We have conflicting estimates on what the work might entail and one estimate ranged from \$400K to \$600K. We will be encumbering those funds for year end as we figure

out how to address that area (whether it can be done in phasing or if the \$100,000 will cover the repairs).

Mayor Lovett asked when the last time Claremont received an LCHIP grant? Ms. Merrill said we received a \$20,000 matching grant 2 years ago and Ms. Merrill said there was something that had gone to the Livingston farm that she didn't know a lot about; Mayor Lovett said she believed we have not received a grant since at least early 2000's.

Ms. Merrill also stated we have Louann from the Opera House taking pictures every time it rains so it can be seen how big the problem is and we will submit pictures as a visual which is always helpful. Mayor Lovett asked how can council help? Would it help to have letters of support? What would be beneficial to the city? Ms. Merrill said that letters of support are helpful and that Rebecca in her office is working on the grant application this week.

Mr. MacLean said LCIP grant is a 50/50 match, so this is something we will have to start discussing. He said there are many ways to do it (whether it's a bond, a capital campaign or fund balance) but it's important to get it out there so people have time to think about it and council will need to look at the options and its impact on our bond rating.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Damren to authorize application of the LCHIP grant.

Voice vote: motion carries 8-0

Acceptance of Donation for Cemetery Gates – Public Hearing

Mary Walter said this requires a public hearing because it is over \$5,000; while the state has changed the limit to \$10,000, we have not updated our approval so she's asking for approval of this donation from the Wood's family. She said that Norma Limoges has been the lead on the gate restoration project and asked if she would like to talk about the donation?

Norma Limoges, the office manager @ DPW, told the Council that nearly five-years ago, while taking a walk in the DPW yard, she stumbled upon (4) large wrought iron gates in the scrap pile. Following an investigation, she determined that the gates once stood at the entrance to Mountain View Cemetery.

She explained that in 1923, Mr. William H. H. Moody, a prominent citizen of Claremont, began an extensive and costly project of placing gates @ the entrance to the park and cemeteries. Mountain View Cemetery was the recipient of four elaborate gates consisting of two pair of double gates and two walk gates. These gates were made by the Stewart Iron Works Company of Cincinnati, Ohio.

Mr. Moody had made a provision in his will to bequeath them to the town; however, he then changed his mind and decided to make them a gift to the town and personally supervise the erection of the gates within his lifetime.

Approximately twenty-years ago, one of the main pillars holding the wrought iron gates to Mountain View Cemetery, was struck by a large truck. The accident caused the pillar to be knocked over and subsequently, the gates fell. The gates were then removed and “stored” in the DPW scrap yard and the pillars were destroyed.

In an effort to restore the heritage of Mr. Moody and reinstate the gates to Mountain View Cemetery, Norma Limoges began a campaign and was able to raise funds from local banks, fraternal organizations, and local citizens. Recently, the City received a check in the amount of \$5,000 from the family of the late Marion Phillips, a former mayor and state senator.

Ms. Limoges said the gates had been restored by the 3-D Welding Company of Claremont and the department was waiting for an engineering report relative to the ability of the new pillars to support the weight of the gates. Following the engineer’s report, the building of the pillars will be advertised for competitive bid. She estimated the project to be completed by summer.

Ms. Limoges said donations are most welcome and can be mailed to the Finance Office, 58 Opera House Square, Claremont, NH 03743. A notation of “cemetery gates” should be included on the check.

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded Ms. Kier to accept with sincere appreciation the donation of \$5,000 towards the Cemetery gate restoration project.

Mayor Lovett opened public hearing, no one spoke and the public hearing was closed.

Roll call vote:

Lessard - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Damren - yes

Kier - yes

Koloski - yes

Pope - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Approval to Insert Flyer into Tax Bills

Mary Walter said at the April meeting when discussing the water/sewer rates that the water department will be going to quarterly billing in the fall. Council had asked about notification to the public and Ms. Walter had stated that we have property tax bills going out in May which

would be a great way to reach everyone. We would need council's approval and would need that at the May meeting if we are going to do it.

Mr. Pope asked if the council needs to approve going to quarterly water billing. Ms. Walter stated that the ordinance passed several years ago was written with the flexibility to do either quarterly or monthly billing without further approval of council. (it was ordinance #435 in 2002)

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Kier to approved the insert into the upcoming tax bill.

Voice vote: motion carries 8-0

Budget Presentation

Mr. MacLean said it has been a pleasure to work with the City staff on the budget this year, and read the following:

On behalf of the city staff, I am pleased to present for your consideration the **Proposed Operating Budget for FY 2020**. In this document, you will find that this team of professionals has held the line on expenditures while looking for creative ways to address longstanding issues. Of course, it is not possible to address every priority in one budget year; however, identifying the need and subsequently building the appropriate foundation of support, is a good first step.

As previously noted, the staff was tasked with holding the line on expenditures, which they did. So much so that this proposed budget does **not** seek an increase in the tax rate, thus holding the municipal portion of the tax rate to last year's rate of \$15.27. Rather, city staff were invited to identify new projects, and new staff positions to be placed on a "supplemental List" that while unfunded, provides them with the opportunity to discuss these requests with the City Council and if desired, could be added into the budget with a modest adjustment to the tax rate.

With this in mind, this year's budget proposes to again use \$500,000.00 from undesignated fund balance to reduce the tax rate. We have also proposed utilizing \$100,000 of fund balance towards Phase II – final design for Pleasant Street, \$11,000 for the JSL (with hopes that the development request will bring

a buyer for the building) and \$206,590 towards the Downtown TIFD (a reduction of over \$80,000 this year).

This budget also captures funds (\$161,000.00) previously used to pay the water utility for hydrant rental, and instead proposes to use these funds to replace three pieces of fire apparatus, the Fire Chief's vehicle, Engine 1, and Engine 2 all of which have been on the fleet replacement list for several years having reached the optimum life expectancy for each vehicle. We are proposing that the Fire Chief's vehicle when replaced, be used by another department, such as building inspection, in order for them to replace a much older vehicle that they have been using thus saving the City the added expense to maintain an obsolete car. In addition, the two existing fire trucks (Engine 1 and 2), can be sold and replaced with one combination 2000-gallon pumper tanker thereby reducing the fleet by one piece of expensive equipment/apparatus and achieving a long-term savings equal to hundreds of thousands of tax dollars. The dollars from the sale of the apparatus can go into their capital replacement reserve thus helping with future apparatus upgrades.

This year's proposed budget includes funding for all negotiated collective bargaining agreements, as well as funds for a modest adjustment for merit plan employees. Additionally, this year's proposed budget provides for \$434,000.00 towards much needed road resurfacing/ reconstruction projects.

This budget does not include funding for Opera House Roof repair/ replacement which is badly needed to preserve this building. It is intended that the City will resubmit its application for a LCHIP Grant and if successful, look to offset the local match with either a capital campaign and/or the use of undesignated fund balance.

Holding the line on expenditures while re-investing in our community

The Capital Improvements Plan (CIP) which was recently approved by the Planning Board contains \$36.5 million in suggested CIP projects and rates them accordingly (1-15 with 15 being the highest priority). We have taken those projects rated 12 and above and those projects alone total \$19.2 million. The City should continue to seek grants and alternative funding sources for capital projects in order to leverage its property tax dollars to the maximum. This can be done through capital campaigns, grants, charitable

gifts, and a gift catalogue of community needs. All the while working towards a sustainable future that invites investment and job creation.

The Fiscal Year 2020 budget is balanced in both the fiscal and policy sense, to ensure Claremont's continued path toward revitalization. I wish to recognize the employees that helped bring the many parts of this endeavor together into one document for the City Council and this great community. All Department Heads and their immediate staff have provided creative leadership in shaping their budgets and various alternatives.

Again, on behalf of your employees, we thank you for the opportunity to serve you and look forward to the year ahead. I recommend this budget to the City Council.

**** A special note of appreciation:** I would be remiss if I didn't mention the incredible contributions that our Finance Director, Mary Walter, makes each year to the financial success of this community. Her institutional memory coupled with accounting skills and sound fiscal judgement, has helped Claremont to get the most from each and every tax dollar we receive. Thank you, Mary, for all that you do for Claremont!

Mr. MacLean then turned it over to Director St. Pierre who introduced his key staff, thanked all his staff for their hard work and especially Norma Limoges who he would be lost without since both he and Mr. Clay are new in these positions. He then did a short overview of the work the 5 divisions of the Public Works Department covered and then presented a power point on the work the department has accomplished in recent years, concluding with what it takes to maintain our roads and get them on a sustainable cycle (\$1.5 million per year).

CLAREMONT'S STREETS & ROADS

- ☐ 44.09 SQUARE MILES
- ☐ POPULATION OF 13,000 +/-
- ☐ 130 +/- MILES OF ROAD – 320 STREETS
- ☐ 260 +/- LANE MILES OF ROAD
- ☐ 35 MILES OF SIDEWALKS

WATER IS THE ENEMY OF ALL ROADS!

Wearing surface should be impervious to water

Once a crack appears, the road deteriorates

The flatter/better the roads, the easier/less expensive it is to maintain

DITCHING

WHAT IS CHIP SEAL?

Chip sealing is a common practice that combines one or more layers of asphalt with one or more layers of fine aggregate.

Chip sealing protects the roads' wearing cover and keeps water from penetrating the paved surfaces. It virtually eliminates the formation of black ice.

Life expectancy of 6-8 years

ROADS – CHIP SEALED - 2019

Elm Street Extension

Veterans Park Road

Winter Street

\$58,270

(to be completed this spring)

WHAT IS CRACK SEAL?

Crack sealing is a process that extends the life of asphalt. It prevents water from infiltrating down to the roads' sub base; thus creating pot holes and alligator cracks.

It also prevents cracks from spreading further.

Life expectancy of 8-years

ROADS – CRACKED SEALED - 2016

Charlestown Road

South Street

Mulberry Street

North Street

Maple Avenue

\$20,000

ROADS – CRACKED SEALED - 2018

Hanover Street

Bowker Street

<i>Myrtle Street</i>	<i>Main Street</i>
<i>Bible Hill Road</i>	<i>Elm Street</i>
<i>Cat Hole Road</i>	<i>Plains Road</i>
<i>Union Street</i>	
	\$68,150

WHAT'S UNDER THE ROAD?

NEW WATER LINE ON LITTLE LANE UNDERGROUND WORK PRIOR TO PAVING

Example: STRINGER LANE -- IN HOUSE CONSTRUCTION

WHAT DOES IT COST TO MAINTAIN ROADS?

SNOW REMOVAL – 2018-2019

Labor/Overtime/Equipment

\$435,290

Salt

\$166,915

Sand

\$28,545

OVERALL COST TO FILL POTHOLES - 1,957 HOURS (one year only)

Labor Cost	\$71,019
Equipment Cost	\$48,489
Asphalt	<u>\$41,074</u>
	\$160,582

PATCHING – WITHOUT FIXING THE ROAD
GRADING/ DUST CONTROL
(31 miles of gravel roads)

COST TO MAINTAIN DIRT ROADS DURING MUD SEASON - 2019

Stone & Gravel Only: - \$36,000

Whitewater Brook Road

Ironwood Hill Road

*Boat Landing Road
E. Green Mt. Road
Spring Farm Road
White Hill Road
Skyline Terrace*

*Foisy Hill Road
Bonneau Road
Hogback Road
Hewitt Road*

LINE PAINTING - \$33,000

- ❖ 227,000 lf of Double Yellow Lines
- ❖ 124,700 lf of White Lines
- ❖ 4,100 lf of Yellow Lines
- ❖ 550 Parking Stalls
- ❖ 200 Stop Bars
- ❖ 150 Crosswalks
- ❖ 125 Line Arrows
- ❖ 25 Arrows
- ❖ 16 Handicap Decals
- ❖ 16 School Zones
- ❖ 10 Railroad Crossings

VEGETATION CONTROL
RECYCLING ASPHALT @ DPW SITE

PAVING PROJECTS – 07/28/17
State of New Hampshire Additional Block
Grant Aid payment of \$277,379.33

City paved portions of Washington & Main Streets

\$88,392 – Main Street

\$164,020–Washington Street

City recycled 1.5” of gravel and moved the gravel to East Green Mountain Road – it helped with the drainage issues.

COST TO PAVE:

W. PLEASANT STREET– \$204,475

BUENA VISTA ROAD - \$48,800

FIRST STREET/SECOND STREET – \$60,000

CENTRAL STREET – PRE-CONDITION \$107,700

SULLIVAN STREET – \$203,500

NORTH/HANOVER INTERSECTION \$20,000

NORTH/ELM INTERSECTION \$40,000

EDWIN AVENUE \$159,000
WALNUT STREET \$40,000
VETERANS PARK/CATHOLE ROAD \$148,000
PEARL STREET \$116,000
CENTENNIAL & CHELLIS STREETS \$144,000

HOW MUCH DID IT COST TO PAVE SEVERANCEVILLE?

Severance Street	\$49,816
Cottage Street	\$50,861
Baker Street	\$29,663
Henry Street	\$46,447

To Include:
10" In-Place Recycling
Adjustments of Catch Basins/Manholes
Hot Mix - Top & Bottom

Remove and Replace New Sidewalks
Bituminous Curbing
Flaggers for Traffic
Mobilization

WHAT STREETS NEED TO BE ADDRESSED IN THE CIP PLAN?

<i>Oakwood Drive</i>	<i>Chase Street</i>	<i>Paddy Hollow Road</i>
<i>Ridge Avenue</i>	<i>Pappas Road</i>	<i>McKenzie Drive</i>
<i>Whitcomb Lane</i>	<i>Durham Avenue</i>	<i>West Terrace Street</i>
<i>Orchard Road</i>	<i>Lafayette Street</i>	<i>Red Water Brook Road</i>
<i>Edgewood Street</i>	<i>Highland Avenue</i>	<i>Twistback Road</i>
<i>Spofford Street</i>	<i>Benton Avenue</i>	<i>Osgood Avenue</i>
<i>Thrasher Road</i>	<i>Clay Hill Road</i>	<i>Hartford Street</i>
<i>Grissom Lane</i>	<i>Francis Street</i>	<i>Winter Street</i>
<i>Acer Heights</i>	<i>Richards Court</i>	<i>Old Newport Road</i>
<i>Myrtle Street</i>	<i>Spruce Street</i>	<i>Schmitt Street</i>
<i>Grove Street</i>	<i>Franklin Street</i>	<i>Slab City Road</i>
<i>Ellery Hill</i>	<i>Parsons Avenue</i>	<i>Highland Avenue</i>
<i>Old Church Road</i>	<i>Bellevue Avenue</i>	<i>Langseth Avenue</i>
<i>Summit Road</i>	<i>East Street ** under contract for \$100,771</i>	

WHAT IS THE APPROXIMATE COST TO PAVE THESE STREETS THIS YEAR

2019

<u>Street</u>	<u>Cost</u>
<i>Red Water Brook Road</i>	<i>\$220,000</i>
<i>West Terrace Street</i>	<i>\$180,000</i>
<i>Edgewood Street</i>	<i>\$ 50,000</i>
<i>Hartford Street</i>	<i>\$ 67,000</i>
<i>Durham Avenue</i>	<i>\$160,000</i>

<i>Oakwood Drive</i>	<i>\$ 40,000</i>
<i>Schmitt Street</i>	<i>\$ 60,000</i>
<i>Osgood Avenue</i>	<i>\$ 50,000</i>
<i>Summit Road</i>	<i>\$ 77,000</i>
<i>Grove Street</i>	<i>\$160,000</i>
<i>Chase Street</i>	<i>\$ 70,000</i>

WHAT IS THE APPROXIMATE COST TO PAVE THESE STREETS in 2020?

<u>Street</u>	<u>Cost</u>
<i>Whitcomb Lane (bottom area)</i>	<i>\$ 20,000</i>
<i>Thrasher Road</i>	<i>\$175,000</i>
<i>Orchard Road</i>	<i>\$ 60,000</i>
<i>Grissom Lane</i>	<i>\$ 100,000</i>
<i>Ridge Avenue</i>	<i>\$ 89,000</i>
<i>Acer Heights</i>	<i>\$ 75,000</i>

WHAT IS THE APPROXIMATE COST TO PAVE THESE STREETS in 2021?

<u>Street</u>	<u>Cost</u>
<i>Winter Street Extension</i>	<i>\$275,000</i>
<i>Washington Street **</i>	<i>\$600,000</i>
<i>Old Newport Road</i>	<i>\$200,000</i>
<i>Spofford Street</i>	<i>\$ 52,000</i>
<i>Highland Avenue</i>	<i>\$ 85,000</i>
<i>McKenzie Drive</i>	<i>\$ 75,000</i>
<i>Parsons Avenue</i>	<i>\$ 20,000</i>
<i>Franklin Street</i>	<i>\$ 60,000</i>
<i>Francis Street</i>	<i>\$ 70,000</i>
<i>Richards Court</i>	<i>\$ 20,000</i>
<i>Spruce Street</i>	<i>\$ 45,000</i>
<i>Clay Hill Road</i>	<i>\$110,000</i>
<i>Pappas Road</i>	<i>\$ 35,000</i>
<i>** Traffic Count of 25,000/day</i>	

WHAT WOULD IT COST TO PAVE all THE ABOVE-MENTIONED STREETS?

\$3,300,000

WHAT WOULD IT COST TO PAVE EACH CITY STREET ONE TIME ON AN AVERAGE
30-YEAR CYCLE?

Reclaim existing asphalt and pave 3" w/structure work = \$66.50/LF or

\$351,120/mile

Average of \$351,120/mile x 130 miles = \$45,645,600

\$45,645,600 divided by 30-years =

\$1,521,520 EACH YEAR

Based on 24' wide road, with traffic control, no underground utility work included

SIDEWALKS COMPLETED

2015 – 2018

Elm Street

Pearl Street

Baker Street

Walnut Street

Myrtle Street

Main Street

Henry Street

Union Street

Maple Avenue

Central Street

Cottage Street

Trinity Street

Sullivan Street

Pleasant Street

Tutherly Heights

Centennial/Chellis

SIDEWALK PROJECT – 2017

MAPLE AVENUE - COMPLETED IN-HOUSE

Sanitation (Transfer Station)

Department Request \$ 192,219.00 City Manager Proposed \$192,219.00

Last year the transfer station processed 360 tons of municipal solid waste, 100 tons of demo material, 100 tons of cardboard, 50 tons of single stream, 50 tons of paper and 60 tons of glass. This has the landfill monitoring and testing.

There is a big increase in revenue.

Mr. MacLean said he does not believe the Transfer Station will ever be cost neutral.

[Note: No public spoke.]

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Damren to tentatively approve the Sanitation (Transfer Station) budget for \$192,219.00.

Voice vote: motion carries 7-1 (Mr. O'Hearne opposed).

Streets & Roads (Highways)

Department Request \$3,301,735.00 City Manager Proposed \$2,959,495.00

Consulting & engineering we need extra help with replacing our culverts, also wetlands permitting.

The main culvert we are working on now is on Washington St.

Director Sweet last year had come back to the council to get \$250,000 for culvert work that included engineering work.

Ms. Kier asked what the impact on the tax rate would be if the Department request was passed? Mary Walter said it would be \$.47 per thousand.

Mr. Damren said he is sensitive to the fleet issue and does not want to tentatively approve this budget in case they want to add anything.

Building extra would be looking to do work on the building as it is a brick building.

Mayor Lovett asked for an explanation for the “department extra” for all of the departments.

Cemetery

Department Request \$194,161.00 City Manager Proposed \$188,761.00

Director St Pierre gave an overview of what the cemetery department does.

Mayor Lovett asked if there was any plan to fix the stones that were damaged by vandalism.

Norma Limoges said gravestones are personal property and we are not allowed to touch those and shrubs are not allowed per the cemetery rules approved by the council.

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Mr. Damren to tentatively approve the Cemetery budget for \$188,761.00

Voice vote: motion carries 5-3 (Mr. O’Hearne, Mr. Stone and Mr. Kier opposed)

Water

Department Request \$1,931,723.00 City Manager Proposed \$1,931,723.00

Director St Pierre gave an overview of the Water Department and the meter change program.

We received a grant for leak detection.

There was a discussion regarding hydrant rentals. Ms. Walter explained that even with the loss in hydrant money from the Fire Department there is ample revenue so that we are still not taking anything from their retained earnings.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Kier to tentatively approve the Water budget for \$1,931,723.00.

Voice vote: motion carries 5-3 (Mr. Koloski, Mr. Stone and Mr. O’Hearne opposed)

Sewer

Department Request \$2,859,554.00 City Manager Proposed \$2,859,554.00

Director St. Pierre gave an overview of the Sewer Department.

Mary Walter said that we just received notice that loan #18 has been substantially completed and we will be getting our first payment of \$187,192 due October 1st. This was not included in the budget as we were just made aware of the substantial completion so we can either add it to the budget out of retained earnings now or come back after July 1 with options. We have some time since it’s not due until October 1.

Mr. MacLean’s suggestion would be a rate increase and to come back with some recommendations.

Mr. St Pierre also brought up a significant growing issue with sewerage treatment. The BioMass plant has been shut down, and we can’t get enough wood ash, or good enough quality wood ash, to properly heat the sludge to compost it. We are looking at options now and one is actually being done in Australia where they dehydrate the sludge making pellets which allows them to be put on fields similar to fertilizer and still allow air and flow into the ground.

Not going to tentatively approve this budget at this time.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Mayor Lovett – gave a status update on the train station (we keep increasing ridership) and the construction of the handicap accessibility which should be done by the end of June. Gave a thank you to the volunteers that are there every day.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Non-public on next agenda for real estate.

Mr. Pope asked if all power-points can be sent to council ahead of time.

Mr. Koloski had sent an email to city admin regarding some budget questions and had asked that it be sent to all councilors.

A motion was made at 9:30pm by Ms. Lovett and seconded by Mr. Pope to go into non-public per RSA 91-A:3, II c and invite the city manager.

Voice vote: motion carries 8-0

A motion was made at 9:45 pm by Mr. O'Hearne and seconded by Ms. Kier to leave the non-public session.

Voice vote: motion carries 8-0

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Ms. Kier to seal the minutes of the non-public session.

Voice vote: motion carries 8-0

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

ADJOURNMENT

At 9:46p.m., a motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Stone to adjourn.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Gwendolyn R. Melcher
City Clerk